

default to Iceweasel I'll press '2'. Here's how the console tells us that the change has been configured:

```
Using '/usr/bin/iceweasel' to provide 'x-www-browser'.
```

Note that the above command requires root privileges.

Similarly, if you want to choose your default Java installation:

```
$ sudo update-alternatives --config java
```

There are 3 alternatives which provide 'java'.

Selection	Alternative
1	/usr/bin/gij-wrapper-4.1
*+ 2	/usr/lib/jvm/java-gcj/jre/bin/java
3	/usr/lib/jvm/java-1.5.0-sun/jre/bin/java

Press enter to keep the default["1"], or type selection number: 3

```
Using '/usr/lib/jvm/java-1.5.0-sun/jre/bin/java' to provide 'java'.
```

Note that we switched from java-gcj to Sun's Java. Let's check if it has indeed become the default:

```
$ java -version
java version "1.5.0_14"
Java(TM) 2 Runtime Environment, Standard Edition (build 1.5.0_14-b03)
Java HotSpot(TM) Client VM (build 1.5.0_14-b03, mixed mode, sharing)
```

—Senthil Kumar S, stylesen@gmail.com



Retrieving data from the RAM

You're working on an important document and the following happens:

- The application crashes!
- You close it without saving
- You save over a document you had just opened!

Solution:

While you've lost what you had on screen, you may have forgotten that the computer still has it stored in the RAM. You just need to find a way to get it.

First things first—every step you take after the realisation of the loss can cause pieces of it to get overwritten (since this memory is now marked as free by the OS). So the first step is to create a snapshot of your current RAM. If you have a lot of RAM, this can

take over 1 GB of space on your hard drive.

```
cp /dev/mem ~/memory.bin
```

After it's done copying, you can access the file using *less*:

```
less ~/memory.bin
```

When the program starts, it'll report that it's trying to compute line numbers. Skip this by hitting *Ctrl+c* once.

Now search for a unique word that you remember, typing in your document by hitting the forward slash (/) followed by the word (e.g., /trickle). After much churning, matches will be displayed. Hit the up and down arrow keys to scroll from the hit point. To continue searching for the same phrase, simply hit '/' and Enter again. Once you stumble upon your document, it may be in bad shape, but there should be enough information left to be copied out of the terminal.

Note:

1. You must be logged in as the root to read the mem device.
2. You will save a lot of file space and make your job easier if you use this line, `cat /dev/mem | strings > ~/memory.bin`

—Bharat kumar, bharatrayudu@gmail.com



Creating secure passwords

Time and again we need to create strong passwords for Web forms, e-mail accounts, Web registration pages, etc. We can create one easily in GNU/Linux using the *openssl* command as follows:

```
openssl rand 12 -base64
```

The above command will create a random base 64 encoding string each time it's run. Since the string you get from the command is different each time the command is run, it's secure and easy to create a strong password this way.

—Swapneel, swapneel@eth1.in

END

Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in LFY so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.linuxforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get an LFY T-shirt.